1. Full length verbal ability — Solutions & Explanations

Infosys Systems Engineer (SE) | 5-6 Nov 2026 Drive | 100% Pure SE Verified

Total Questions: 25 | **Total Marks:** 25

Section: Verbal Ability

Problem 1 • Find the Error in the following sentences. Q1. Behave yourself; [1] lest you [2] should not [3] invite the wrath of the old man [4].

PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q1 | Source: Infosys PYQ | Level: Infosys SE Standard

Find the Error in the following sentences. Q1. Behave yourself; [1] lest you [2] should not [3] invite the wrath of the old man [4].

A 1

B 2

D 4

Verified Answer: Option (C) > 💡 **Explanation:** > Ans - C > 🎥 **Video Solution:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bOIO2MSdNwM #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 2 • Find the Error in the following sentences. Q2. [1] Hardly [2] had 1 [3] climbed the stairs [4] than I was called down again.

PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q2 | Source: Infosys PYQ | Level: Infosys SE Standard

Find the Error in the following sentences. Q2. [1] Hardly [2] had 1 [3] climbed the stairs [4] than I was called down again.

A 1

B 2

C 3

Verified Answer: Option (D) > 💡 **Explanation:** > Ans - D > 🎥 **Video Solution:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jFLdBxN-nt4 #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 3 • SENTENCE CORRECTION Though all competitive exams do not allow using a calculator , but where they are permitted, there are restrictions on the models allowed.

○ PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q3 | Source: Infosys PYQ | Level: Infosys SE Standard

SENTENCE CORRECTION Though all competitive exams do not allow using a calculator , but where they are permitted, there are restrictions on the models allowed.

A Though all competitive exams do not allow using calculators

C Every competitive exam does not allow using of calculators

D No correction required

✓ **Verified Answer:** Option (B) > 💡 **Explanation:** > Ans - B > 🎥 **Video Solution:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bG-XEwPb2Os #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 4 • SENTENCE CORRECTION Researchers have recently discovered a bacteria, Ideonella sakaiensis, in a recycling plant that eats one of the most common forms of plastic.

○ PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q4 | Source: Infosys PYQ | Level: Infosys SE Standard

SENTENCE CORRECTION Researchers have recently discovered a bacteria, Ideonella sakaiensis, in a recycling plant that eats one of the most common forms of plastic.

A a bacteria, Ideonella sakaiensis, that eats one of the most common forms of plastic in a recycling plant.

B Ideonella sakaiensis, a bacteria that eats one of the most common forms of plastic, in a recycling plant.

C a bacterium that eats one of the most common forms of plastic, Ideonella sakaiensis, in a recycling plant.

✓ **Verified Answer:** Option (D) > 💡 **Explanation:** > Ans - D > 🎥 **Video Solution:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Xy8H4Ct-nhU #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 5 • Antonym Q. Laconic

○ PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q5 | Source: Infosys PYQ | Level: Infosys SE Standard

Antonym Q. Laconic

A Profligate

B Bucolic

C Prolific

✓ **Verified Answer:** Option (D) > 💡 **Explanation:** > Ans - D > 🎥 **Video Solution:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=erD2QIlvo00 #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 6 • Antonym Q. Copious ◯ PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q6 Source: Infosys PYQ Level: Infosys SE Standard

Antonym Q. Copious

B Abundant

C Pious

D Nadir

✓ **Verified Answer:** Option (A) > 💡 **Explanation:** > Ans - A > 🎥 **Video Solution:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zp5ZLvgHD7g #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 7 • Synonym Q. Gusto ◯ PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q7 Source: Infosys PYQ Level: Infosys SE Standard

Synonym Q. Gusto

B Lampooning

C Bellicose

D Ambush

✓ **Verified Answer:** Option (A) > 💡 **Explanation:** > Ans - A > 🎥 **Video Solution:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vYX0mKFiz00 #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 8 • Read each sentence to find out whether there is any grammatical or idiomatic error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. The number of that part is the answer. If the sentence is error-free then choose "No error" as your answer choice. (Ignore errors of punctuation, if any.) He is almost quite competent (A)/ for the post of Manager; (B)/ so when given a chance, (c)/he can lead the company to its goal (D) ◯ PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q8 Source: Infosys PYQ Level: Infosys SE Standard

Read each sentence to find out whether there is any grammatical or idiomatic error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. The number of that part is the answer. If the sentence is error-free then choose "No error" as your answer choice. (Ignore errors of punctuation, if any.) He is almost quite competent (A)/ for the post of Manager; (B)/ so when given a chance, (c)/he can lead the company to its goal (D)

B B

C C

D D

E No Error

✓ **Verified Answer:** Option (A) > 💡 **Explanation:** > Sol. 'almost' will not be used here because Adverb is not used before 'quite'. #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 9 • Which of these words is closest in meaning to the word provided? Remote ◯ PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q9 Source: Infosys PYQ Level: Infosys SE Standard

Which of these words is closest in meaning to the word provided? Remote

B Distant

C Savage

D Mean

✓ **Verified Answer:** Option (A) > **Video Solution:** images/img_76a14e4f2dd1.png #

Problem 10 • Read each sentence to find out whether there is any grammatical or idiomatic error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. The number of that part is the answer. If the sentence is error-free then choose "No error" as your answer choice. (Ignore errors of punctuation, if any.) The population density of (a)/ China is (b)/ greater (c)/ than America(d) ◯ PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q10 Source: Infosys PYQ Level: Infosys SE Standard

Read each sentence to find out whether there is any grammatical or idiomatic error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. The number of that part is the answer. If the sentence is error-free then choose "No error" as your answer choice. (Ignore errors of punctuation, if any.) The population density of (a)/ China is (b)/ greater (c)/ than America(d)

A a

B b

C c

✓ **Verified Answer:** Option (D) > **Video Solution:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O6y0VffvTIY #

Problem 11 • DIRECTION: Choose the option which represents the best way of writing the Sentence ◯ PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q11 Source: Infosys PYQ Level: Infosys SE Standard

DIRECTION: Choose the option which represents the best way of writing the Sentence

A This teacher, along with a few others, play the guitar during the leisure time.

C This teacher, along with a few others, are playing the guitar during the leisure time.

D This teacher, along with a few others, were playing the guitar during the leisure time

✓ **Verified Answer:** Option (B) > **Video Solution:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2gqzYDzHEac #

Problem 12 • DIRECTION: Choose the option which represents the best way of writing the Sentence

PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q12 Source: Infosys PYQ Level: Infosys SE Standard

DIRECTION: Choose the option which represents the best way of writing the Sentence

A Two-thirds of the city seem to be in ruins due to covid-19

B Two-thirds of the city are in ruins due to covid-19

C Two-thirds of the city seeming ruins due to covid-19

✓ **Verified Answer:** Option (D) > 🎥 **Video Solution:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WjZOtE3SBYc #

Problem 13 • The rotten smell was so _____ that she became unconscious then and there and had to be hospitalized.

PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q13 Source: Infosys PYQ Level: Infosys SE Standard

The rotten smell was so _____ that she became unconscious then and there and had to be hospitalized.

B gratifying

C captivating

D unappealing

E All of the above

✓ **Verified Answer:** Option (A) > 💡 **Explanation:** > Rotten smell is never pleasant. Besides, 'she' became unconscious smelling it. So, the smell was not pleasing for sure. The words 'gratifying' and 'captivating' are synonymous with 'pleasing'. Hence, these words can be eliminated. "Unappealing" is not a very strong word and consequently won't fit here. The context demands a very strong word as 'she' became 'unconscious' smelling the rotten odour. Only "revolting" fits the blank appropriately both contextually and grammatically. "Revolting" means causing intense disgust; disgusting Hence, option A is the correct answer. #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 14 • The government should A. to improve B. introduce policies C. the quality of education D. in government schools

PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q14 Source: Infosys PYQ Level: Infosys SE Standard

The government should A. to improve B. introduce policies C. the quality of education D. in government schools

A DBAC

B DBAC

C ACDB

✓ **Verified Answer:** Option (D) > 🎥 **Video Solution:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oON8OZAkEyY #

Problem 15 • Directions: In the given statements, a blank has been given. This needs to be filled up using the correct combination of words from the three options mentioned, so that the resulting statement is grammatically and contextually correct. People of different communities should not harbor grudge against each other, rather, they should celebrate fellow-feeling and _____ amongst each other. I. friendship II. fraternity III. brotherhood

PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q15 | Source: Infosys PYQ | Level: Infosys SE Standard

Directions: In the given statements, a blank has been given. This needs to be filled up using the correct combination of words from the three options mentioned, so that the resulting statement is grammatically and contextually correct. People of different communities should not harbor grudge against each other, rather, they should celebrate fellow-feeling and _____ amongst each other. I. friendship II. fraternity III. brotherhood

A Only I

B Only I and III

C Only II and III

D Only I and II

✓ **Verified Answer:** Option (E) > 💡 **Explanation:** > "Fellow-feeling" means 'sympathy and fellowship existing between people based on shared experiences or feelings'. "Fellow-feeling" and the blank is connected by the connector 'and'. Hence the blank will take a word similar to the word 'fellow-feeling'. Fraternity: friendship and mutual support within a group "Fraternity", "friendship" and "brotherhood" are very similar to fellow-feeling. All the three words fit perfectly in the blank. Hence, option E is the correct answer. #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 16 • Directions: Rearrange the following six sentences A, B, C, D, E, and F in the proper sequence to form a meaningful paragraph and then answer the question given beside. 1. Children are growing up surrounded by mobile devices and interactive social networking sites. 2. The effects of social networking are two fold. 3. The impact of social networks on them is significant. 4. While on the negative side, the internet is laden with a number of risks associated with online communities. 5. Social media is a term used to describe the interaction between groups or individuals over the internet and in virtual communities. 6. On the positive side, social networks can act as invaluable tools for professionals Which of the following would be the FIRST sentence after rearrangement?

PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q16 Source: Infosys PYQ Level: Infosys SE Standard

Directions: Rearrange the following six sentences A, B, C, D, E, and F in the proper sequence to form a meaningful paragraph and then answer the question given beside. 1. Children are growing up surrounded by mobile devices and interactive social networking sites. 2. The effects of social networking are two fold. 3. The impact of social networks on them is significant. 4. While on the negative side, the internet is laden with a number of risks associated with online communities. 5. Social media is a term used to describe the interaction between groups or individuals over the internet and in virtual communities. 6. On the positive side, social networks can act as invaluable tools for professionals Which of the following would be the FIRST sentence after rearrangement?

A undefined

Verified Answer: Option () > 💡 **Explanation:** > Correct Sequence : E – A – C – B– F– D. Hints : The subject that is being discussed in the passage is the effect of social media over individuals and society. If we think about the opening sentence we will first try to eliminate odd sentences. Sentences A and E appear to be the guesses. As sentence E starts an introduction about social media, the paragraph has to start with sentence E. It introduces to us what social media is and how individuals use it. Sentence A then immediately follows because it tells us how the world is changing and how the children are growing up surrounded by social media. Sentence B immediately follows as it mentions that the effects are in two parts. Sentences D & F can't be the following sentence as they would come after sentence B. Sentences D and F explain the positive and negative impacts of social media. "Social networking" to "social networks", "children" to "them" Now sentence D is the last sentence as it tells us the negative side of social networking The final sequence of the sentences is E – A – C – B– F– D. #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 17 • Directions: Rearrange the following six sentences A, B, C, D, E, and F in the proper sequence to form a meaningful paragraph and then answer the question given beside. 1. Children are growing up surrounded by mobile devices and interactive social networking sites. 2. The effects of social networking are two fold. 3. The impact of social networks on them is significant. 4. While on the negative side, the internet is laden with a number of risks associated with online communities. 5. Social media is a term used to describe the interaction between groups or individuals over the internet and in virtual communities. 6. On the positive side, social networks can act as invaluable tools for professionals Which of the following would be the THIRD sentence after rearrangement?

PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q17 Source: Infosys PYQ Level: Infosys SE Standard

Directions: Rearrange the following six sentences A, B, C, D, E, and F in the proper sequence to form a meaningful paragraph and then answer the question given beside. 1. Children are growing up surrounded by mobile devices and interactive social networking sites. 2. The effects of social networking are two fold. 3. The impact of social networks on them is significant. 4. While on the negative side, the internet is laden with a number of risks associated with online communities. 5. Social media is a term used to describe the interaction between groups or individuals over the internet and in virtual communities. 6. On the positive side, social networks can act as invaluable tools for professionals Which of the following would be the THIRD sentence after rearrangement?

A undefined

Verified Answer: Option () > 💡 **Explanation:** > Correct Sequence : E – A – C – B– F– D. Hints : The subject that is being discussed in the passage is the effect of social media over individuals and society. If we think about the opening sentence we will first try to eliminate odd sentences. Sentences A and E appear to be the guesses. As sentence E starts an introduction about social media, the paragraph has to start with sentence E. It introduces to us what social media is and how individuals use it. Sentence A then immediately follows because it tells us how the world is changing and how the children are growing up surrounded by social media. Sentence B immediately follows as it mentions that the effects are in two parts. Sentences D & F can't be the following sentence as they would come after sentence B. Sentences D and F explain the positive and negative impacts of social media. "Social networking" to "social networks", "children" to "them" Now sentence D is the last sentence as it tells us the negative side of social networking The final sequence of the sentences is E – A – C – B– F– D. #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 18 • Directions: Rearrange the following six sentences A, B, C, D, E, and F in the proper sequence to form a meaningful paragraph and then answer the question given beside. 1. Children are growing up surrounded by mobile devices and interactive social networking sites. 2. The effects of social networking are two fold. 3. The impact of social networks on them is significant. 4. While on the negative side, the internet is laden with a number of risks associated with online communities. 5. Social media is a term used to describe the interaction between groups or individuals over the internet and in virtual communities. 6. On the positive side, social networks can act as invaluable tools for professionals Which of the following would be the LAST sentence after rearrangement?

PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q18 Source: Infosys PYQ Level: Infosys SE Standard

Directions: Rearrange the following six sentences A, B, C, D, E, and F in the proper sequence to form a meaningful paragraph and then answer the question given beside. 1. Children are growing up surrounded by mobile devices and interactive social networking sites. 2. The effects of social networking are two fold. 3. The impact of social networks on them is significant. 4. While on the negative side, the internet is laden with a number of risks associated with online communities. 5. Social media is a term used to describe the interaction between groups or individuals over the internet and in virtual communities. 6. On the positive side, social networks can act as invaluable tools for professionals Which of the following would be the LAST sentence after rearrangement?

A undefined

Verified Answer: Option () > 💡 **Explanation:** > Correct Sequence : E – A – C – B– F– D. Hints : The subject that is being discussed in the passage is the effect of social media over individuals and society. If we think about the opening sentence we will first try to eliminate odd sentences. Sentences A and E appear to be the guesses. As sentence E starts an introduction about social media, the paragraph has to start with sentence E. It introduces to us what social media is and how individuals use it. Sentence A then immediately follows because it tells us how the world is changing and how the children are growing up surrounded by social media. Sentence B immediately follows as it mentions that the effects are in two parts. Sentences D & F can't be the following sentence as they would come after sentence B. Sentences D and F explain the positive and negative impacts of social media. "Social networking" to "social networks", "children" to "them" Now sentence D is the last sentence as it tells us the negative side of social networking The final sequence of the sentences is E – A – C – B– F– D. #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 19 • Directions: Read the following passage to answer the given questions based on it. Some words/phrases are printed in bold to help you locate them while answering some of the questions. (The passage has been extracted from 'The Hindu' dated June 11, 2014.) Ever since the morning after 26/11, India's strategic community has discussed what the country ought to do when the next 26/11 happens. Prime Minister Narendra Modi may have to answer that question sooner than most people expect. The Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) staged its first operation against an Indian target since 26/11 just hours before Mr. Modi took office, attacking India's mission in Herat. Lashkar chief Hafiz Muhammad Saeed blamed Mr. Modi for this week's attacks on Karachi — and demanded vengeance. From past evidence, we know these threats aren't idle . "The only language India understands is that of force," a press release issued by the Lashkar's parent organisation, Jamaat-ud-Dawa recorded Mr. Saeed as saying before 26/11, "and that is the language it must be talked to in." From files he will have read since taking office, Mr. Modi will have learned why Dr. Singh did nothing. Indian combat jets could hit training camps across the Line of Control (LoC), Air Chief Marshal Fali Major said at a November 29 meeting called for by the Prime Minister, but precise coordinates and adequate imaging weren't available. Later, General Deepak Kapoor, the chief of Army staff, told Dr. Singh he couldn't promise special forces' strikes would be successful either. No one could guarantee missile strikes wouldn't escalate into war, or even a nuclear exchange — and no one could guarantee war would compel Pakistan's military to change course. Mr. Modi's advisers know five responses are on the table — but all of them involve great risks. The first is to keep doing nothing. The threat of a major India-Pakistan crisis after 26/11 led the United States to mount intense pressure on Pakistan. In the years since, the LeT hasn't mounted a single major operation on Indian soil. Its affiliate, the Indian Mujahideen, has had restraint thrust upon it by Pakistan's Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI) Directorate. Inaction, though, only succeeds if someone else does the hard work. In 2008, fearing its own war in Afghanistan would be undermined by an India-Pakistan war, the U.S. stepped in. Now, as it prepares to withdraw from Afghanistan, the country's appetite for playing global policeman is diminishing. Doing nothing could thus invite even more punishment. Like Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Mr. Modi's second choice might be coercion. In 2001, after terrorists attacked Parliament, India mobilised troops. Pakistan was forced to respond — but its smaller economy suffered disproportionately. The stratagem is time-tested. In 1953, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru mobilised troops in Punjab to deter a Pakistani attack into Kashmir. Mr. Vajpayee's strategy worked, forcing Pakistan to dramatically scale down the jihad in Jammu and Kashmir. It only worked, though, because the U.S. played mediator — much like after 26/11 — and it was hideously expensive, in money and lives. The third choice is to do what Dr. Singh couldn't: limited strikes on jihadist training camps across the LoC, using air power or missiles. In the five years since 26/11, India's ability to conduct such strikes has been significantly enhanced. However, the tactic hasn't had great success. In August 1998, the United States fired missiles into Afghanistan, seeking to avenge bombings which killed 224 people. In all, 75 missiles, each priced at $1.5 million, killed six minor jihadists. Moreover, Pakistan could hit back, targeting Indian industrial infrastructure, which is much more expensive than tent-and-donkey cart training camps. Fourth, the Prime Minister could tell Indian troops to target the Pakistan Army along the LoC, using artillery and infantry — a task aided by the fact that its defences along stretches of the Neelam valley have been degraded by troops having to be moved to fight the Tehreek-e-Taliban elsewhere. The fighting that will follow though will make it more difficult to secure the LoC against jihadist infiltration — leading to heightened violence in Kashmir. Mr. Modi could, finally, authorise the use of covert means, like bomb-for-bomb strikes or targeted assassination of jihadist leaders. Mr. Modi's intelligence services, though, don't have this arrow in their quiver — and it will be a while, most experts say, before they can acquire it. Every sane person should hope Mr. Modi will never be required to exercise any of his military options — but thinking through war is just as important as talking peace. 1. What is the major reason according to the passage is for the Lashkar-e-Taiba not mounting a major operation on Indian soil after 26/11?

○ PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q19 Source: Infosys PYQ Level: Infosys SE Standard

Directions: Read the following passage to answer the given questions based on it. Some words/phrases are printed in bold to help you locate them while answering some of the questions. (The passage has been extracted from 'The Hindu' dated June 11, 2014.) Ever since the morning after 26/11, India's strategic community has discussed what the country ought to do when the next 26/11 happens. Prime Minister Narendra Modi may have to answer that question sooner than most people expect. The Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) staged its first operation against an Indian target since 26/11 just hours before Mr. Modi took office, attacking India's mission in Herat. Lashkar chief Hafiz Muhammad Saeed blamed Mr. Modi for this week's attacks on Karachi — and demanded vengeance. From past evidence, we know these threats aren't idle . "The only language India understands is that of force," a press release issued by the Lashkar's parent organisation, Jamaat-ud-Dawa recorded Mr. Saeed as saying before 26/11, "and that is the language it must be talked to in." From files he will have read since taking office, Mr. Modi will have learned why Dr. Singh did nothing. Indian combat jets could hit training camps across the Line of Control (LoC), Air Chief Marshal Fali Major said at a November 29 meeting called for by the Prime Minister, but precise coordinates and adequate imaging weren't available. Later, General Deepak Kapoor, the chief of Army staff, told Dr. Singh he couldn't promise special forces' strikes would be successful either. No one could guarantee missile strikes wouldn't escalate into war, or even a nuclear exchange — and no one could guarantee war would compel Pakistan's military to change course. Mr. Modi's advisers know five responses are on the table — but all of them involve great risks. The first is to keep doing nothing. The threat of a major India- Pakistan crisis after 26/11 led the United States to mount intense pressure on Pakistan. In the years since, the LeT hasn't mounted a single major operation on Indian soil. Its affiliate, the Indian Mujahideen, has had restraint thrust upon it by Pakistan's Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI) Directorate. Inaction, though, only succeeds if someone else does the hard work. In 2008, fearing its own war in Afghanistan would be undermined by an India-Pakistan war, the U.S. stepped in. Now, as it prepares to withdraw from Afghanistan, the country's appetite for playing global policeman is diminishing. Doing nothing could thus invite even more punishment. Like Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Mr. Modi's second choice might be coercion. In 2001, after terrorists attacked Parliament, India mobilised troops. Pakistan was forced to respond — but its smaller economy suffered disproportionately. The stratagem is time-tested. In 1953, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru mobilised troops in Punjab to deter a Pakistani attack into Kashmir. Mr. Vajpayee's strategy worked, forcing Pakistan to dramatically scale down the jihad in Jammu and Kashmir. It only worked, though, because the U.S. played mediator — much like after 26/11 — and it was hideously expensive, in money and lives. The third choice is to do what Dr. Singh couldn't: limited strikes on jihadist training camps across the LoC, using air power or missiles. In the five years since 26/11, India's ability to conduct such strikes has been significantly enhanced. However, the tactic hasn't had great success. In August 1998, the United States fired missiles into Afghanistan, seeking to avenge bombings which killed 224 people. In all, 75 missiles, each priced at $1.5 million, killed six minor jihadists. Moreover, Pakistan could hit back, targeting Indian industrial infrastructure, which is much more expensive than tent-and-donkey cart training camps. Fourth, the Prime Minister could tell Indian troops to target the Pakistan Army along the LoC, using artillery and infantry — a task aided by the fact that its defences along stretches of the Neelam valley have been degraded by troops having to be moved to fight the Tehreek-e-Taliban elsewhere. The fighting that will follow though will make it more difficult to secure the LoC against jihadist infiltration — leading to heightened violence in Kashmir. Mr. Modi could, finally, authorise the use of covert means, like bomb-for-bomb strikes or targeted assassination of jihadist leaders. Mr. Modi's intelligence services, though, don't have this arrow in their quiver — and it will be a while, most experts say, before they can acquire it. Every sane person should hope Mr. Modi will never be required to exercise any of his military options — but thinking through war is just as important as talking peace. 1. What is the major reason according to the passage is for the Lashkar-e-Taiba not mounting a major operation on Indian soil after 26/11?

A	Due to India's enhanced security after 26/11	B	Due to India's serious dialogue with Pakistan
D	Because the outfit lost its Chief in an accident	E	None of these

Verified Answer: Option (C) > 💡 **Explanation:** > Kindly refer to the 3rd and 4th sentences of the 5th paragraph. #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 20 • Directions: Read the following passage to answer the given questions based on it. Some words/phrases are printed in bold to help you locate them while answering some of the questions. (The passage has been extracted from 'The Hindu' dated June 11, 2014.) Ever since the morning after 26/11, India's strategic community has discussed what the country ought to do when the next 26/11 happens. Prime Minister Narendra Modi may have to answer that question sooner than most people expect. The Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) staged its first operation against an Indian target since 26/11 just hours before Mr. Modi took office, attacking India's mission in Herat. Lashkar chief Hafiz Muhammad Saeed blamed Mr. Modi for this week's attacks on Karachi — and demanded vengeance. From past evidence, we know these threats aren't idle . "The only language India understands is that of force," a press release issued by the Lashkar's parent organisation, Jamaat-ud-Dawa recorded Mr. Saeed as saying before 26/11, "and that is the language it must be talked to in." From files he will have read since taking office, Mr. Modi will have learned why Dr. Singh did nothing. Indian combat jets could hit training camps across the Line of Control (LoC), Air Chief Marshal Fali Major said at a November 29 meeting called for by the Prime Minister, but precise coordinates and adequate imaging weren't available. Later, General Deepak Kapoor, the chief of Army staff, told Dr. Singh he couldn't promise special forces' strikes would be successful either. No one could guarantee missile strikes wouldn't escalate into war, or even a nuclear exchange — and no one could guarantee war would compel Pakistan's military to change course. Mr. Modi's advisers know five responses are on the table — but all of them involve great risks. The first is to keep doing nothing. The threat of a major India-Pakistan crisis after 26/11 led the United States to mount intense pressure on Pakistan. In the years since, the LeT hasn't mounted a single major operation on Indian soil. Its affiliate, the Indian Mujahideen, has had restraint thrust upon it by Pakistan's Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI) Directorate. Inaction, though, only succeeds if someone else does the hard work. In 2008, fearing its own war in Afghanistan would be undermined by an India-Pakistan war, the U.S. stepped in. Now, as it prepares to withdraw from Afghanistan, the country's appetite for playing global policeman is diminishing. Doing nothing could thus invite even more punishment. Like Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Mr. Modi's second choice might be coercion. In 2001, after terrorists attacked Parliament, India mobilised troops. Pakistan was forced to respond — but its smaller economy suffered disproportionately. The stratagem is time-tested. In 1953, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru mobilised troops in Punjab to deter a Pakistani attack into Kashmir. Mr. Vajpayee's strategy worked, forcing Pakistan to dramatically scale down the jihad in Jammu and Kashmir. It only worked, though, because the U.S. played mediator — much like after 26/11 — and it was hideously expensive, in money and lives. The third choice is to do what Dr. Singh couldn't: limited strikes on jihadist training camps across the LoC, using air power or missiles. In the five years since 26/11, India's ability to conduct such strikes has been significantly enhanced. However, the tactic hasn't had great success. In August 1998, the United States fired missiles into Afghanistan, seeking to avenge bombings which killed 224 people. In all, 75 missiles, each priced at $1.5 million, killed six minor jihadists. Moreover, Pakistan could hit back, targeting Indian industrial infrastructure, which is much more expensive than tent-and-donkey cart training camps. Fourth, the Prime Minister could tell Indian troops to target the Pakistan Army along the LoC, using artillery and infantry — a task aided by the fact that its defences along stretches of the Neelam valley have been degraded by troops having to be moved to fight the Tehreek-e-Taliban elsewhere. The fighting that will follow though will make it more difficult to secure the LoC against jihadist infiltration — leading to heightened violence in Kashmir. Mr. Modi could, finally, authorise the use of covert means, like bomb-for-bomb strikes or targeted assassination of jihadist leaders. Mr. Modi's intelligence services, though, don't have this arrow in their quiver — and it will be a while, most experts say, before they can acquire it. Every sane person should hope Mr. Modi will never be required to exercise any of his military options — but thinking through war is just as important as talking peace. 1. Which of the following statements according to the passage is not true?

○ PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q20 | Source: Infosys PYQ | Level: Infosys SE Standard

Directions: Read the following passage to answer the given questions based on it. Some words/phrases are printed in bold to help you locate them while answering some of the questions. (The passage has been extracted from 'The Hindu' dated June 11, 2014.) Ever since the morning after 26/11, India's strategic community has discussed what the country ought to do when the next 26/11 happens. Prime Minister Narendra Modi may have to answer that question sooner than most people expect. The Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) staged its first operation against an Indian target since 26/11 just hours before Mr. Modi took office, attacking India's mission in Herat. Lashkar chief Hafiz Muhammad Saeed blamed Mr. Modi for this week's attacks on Karachi — and demanded vengeance. From past evidence, we know these threats aren't idle . "The only language India understands is that of force," a press release issued by the Lashkar's parent organisation, Jamaat-ud-Dawa recorded Mr. Saeed as saying before 26/11, "and that is the language it must be talked to in." From files he will have read since taking office, Mr. Modi will have learned why Dr. Singh did nothing. Indian combat jets could hit training camps across the Line of Control (LoC), Air Chief Marshal Fali Major said at a November 29 meeting called for by the Prime Minister, but precise coordinates and adequate imaging weren't available. Later, General Deepak Kapoor, the chief of Army staff, told Dr. Singh he couldn't promise special forces' strikes would be successful either. No one could guarantee missile strikes wouldn't escalate into war, or even a nuclear exchange — and no one could guarantee war would compel Pakistan's military to change course. Mr. Modi's advisers know five responses are on the table — but all of them involve great risks. The first is to keep doing nothing. The threat of a major India- Pakistan crisis after 26/11 led the United States to mount intense pressure on Pakistan. In the years since, the LeT hasn't mounted a single major operation on Indian soil. Its affiliate, the Indian Mujahideen, has had restraint thrust upon it by Pakistan's Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI) Directorate. Inaction, though, only succeeds if someone else does the hard work. In 2008, fearing its own war in Afghanistan would be undermined by an India-Pakistan war, the U.S. stepped in. Now, as it prepares to withdraw from Afghanistan, the country's appetite for playing global policeman is diminishing. Doing nothing could thus invite even more punishment. Like Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Mr. Modi's second choice might be coercion. In 2001, after terrorists attacked Parliament, India mobilised troops. Pakistan was forced to respond — but its smaller economy suffered disproportionately. The stratagem is time-tested. In 1953, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru mobilised troops in Punjab to deter a Pakistani attack into Kashmir. Mr. Vajpayee's strategy worked, forcing Pakistan to dramatically scale down the jihad in Jammu and Kashmir. It only worked, though, because the U.S. played mediator — much like after 26/11 — and it was hideously expensive, in money and lives. The third choice is to do what Dr. Singh couldn't: limited strikes on jihadist training camps across the LoC, using air power or missiles. In the five years since 26/11, India's ability to conduct such strikes has been significantly enhanced. However, the tactic hasn't had great success. In August 1998, the United States fired missiles into Afghanistan, seeking to avenge bombings which killed 224 people. In all, 75 missiles, each priced at $1.5 million, killed six minor jihadists. Moreover, Pakistan could hit back, targeting Indian industrial infrastructure, which is much more expensive than tent-and-donkey cart training camps. Fourth, the Prime Minister could tell Indian troops to target the Pakistan Army along the LoC, using artillery and infantry — a task aided by the fact that its defences along stretches of the Neelam valley have been degraded by troops having to be moved to fight the Tehreek-e-Taliban elsewhere. The fighting that will follow though will make it more difficult to secure the LoC against jihadist infiltration — leading to heightened violence in Kashmir. Mr. Modi could, finally, authorise the use of covert means, like bomb-for-bomb strikes or targeted assassination of jihadist leaders. Mr. Modi's intelligence services, though, don't have this arrow in their quiver — and it will be a while, most experts say, before they can acquire it. Every sane person should hope Mr. Modi will never be required to exercise any of his military options — but thinking through war is just as important as talking peace. 1. Which of the following statements according to the passage is not true?

B Dr M. M. Singh did almost nothing in response to 26/11 attacks.

C Fighting the Pakistan Army along the LoC head-on may make it more difficult to secure the LoC against jihadist infiltration.

D A war with Pakistan could not guarantee peace after 26/11.

Verified Answer: Option (A) > 💡 **Explanation:** > 1. The answer can easily be inferred from the 7th paragraph. #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 21 • Directions: Read the following passage to answer the given questions based on it. Some words/phrases are printed in bold to help you locate them while answering some of the questions. (The passage has been extracted from 'The Hindu' dated June 11, 2014.) Ever since the morning after 26/11, India's strategic community has discussed what the country ought to do when the next 26/11 happens. Prime Minister Narendra Modi may have to answer that question sooner than most people expect. The Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) staged its first operation against an Indian target since 26/11 just hours before Mr. Modi took office, attacking India's mission in Herat. Lashkar chief Hafiz Muhammad Saeed blamed Mr. Modi for this week's attacks on Karachi — and demanded vengeance. From past evidence, we know these threats aren't idle . "The only language India understands is that of force," a press release issued by the Lashkar's parent organisation, Jamaat-ud-Dawa recorded Mr. Saeed as saying before 26/11, "and that is the language it must be talked to in." From files he will have read since taking office, Mr. Modi will have learned why Dr. Singh did nothing. Indian combat jets could hit training camps across the Line of Control (LoC), Air Chief Marshal Fali Major said at a November 29 meeting called for by the Prime Minister, but precise coordinates and adequate imaging weren't available. Later, General Deepak Kapoor, the chief of Army staff, told Dr. Singh he couldn't promise special forces' strikes would be successful either. No one could guarantee missile strikes wouldn't escalate into war, or even a nuclear exchange — and no one could guarantee war would compel Pakistan's military to change course. Mr. Modi's advisers know five responses are on the table — but all of them involve great risks. The first is to keep doing nothing. The threat of a major India-Pakistan crisis after 26/11 led the United States to mount intense pressure on Pakistan. In the years since, the LeT hasn't mounted a single major operation on Indian soil. Its affiliate, the Indian Mujahideen, has had restraint thrust upon it by Pakistan's Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI) Directorate. Inaction, though, only succeeds if someone else does the hard work. In 2008, fearing its own war in Afghanistan would be undermined by an India-Pakistan war, the U.S. stepped in. Now, as it prepares to withdraw from Afghanistan, the country's appetite for playing global policeman is diminishing. Doing nothing could thus invite even more punishment. Like Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Mr. Modi's second choice might be coercion. In 2001, after terrorists attacked Parliament, India mobilised troops. Pakistan was forced to respond — but its smaller economy suffered disproportionately. The stratagem is time-tested. In 1953, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru mobilised troops in Punjab to deter a Pakistani attack into Kashmir. Mr. Vajpayee's strategy worked, forcing Pakistan to dramatically scale down the jihad in Jammu and Kashmir. It only worked, though, because the U.S. played mediator — much like after 26/11 — and it was hideously expensive, in money and lives. The third choice is to do what Dr. Singh couldn't: limited strikes on jihadist training camps across the LoC, using air power or missiles. In the five years since 26/11, India's ability to conduct such strikes has been significantly enhanced. However, the tactic hasn't had great success. In August 1998, the United States fired missiles into Afghanistan, seeking to avenge bombings which killed 224 people. In all, 75 missiles, each priced at $1.5 million, killed six minor jihadists. Moreover, Pakistan could hit back, targeting Indian industrial infrastructure, which is much more expensive than tent-and-donkey cart training camps. Fourth, the Prime Minister could tell Indian troops to target the Pakistan Army along the LoC, using artillery and infantry — a task aided by the fact that its defences along stretches of the Neelam valley have been degraded by troops having to be moved to fight the Tehreek-e-Taliban elsewhere. The fighting that will follow though will make it more difficult to secure the LoC against jihadist infiltration — leading to heightened violence in Kashmir. Mr. Modi could, finally, authorise the use of covert means, like bomb-for-bomb strikes or targeted assassination of jihadist leaders. Mr. Modi's intelligence services, though, don't have this arrow in their quiver — and it will be a while, most experts say, before they can acquire it. Every sane person should hope Mr. Modi will never be required to exercise any of his military options — but thinking through war is just as important as talking peace. What according to the passage could be a way to respond to Pakistan after 26/11 attacks? I. To persuade Pakistan forcefully to stop the terror acts on India. II. To launch limited strikes on jihadist training camps across the border. III. To target assassination of jihadist leaders.

PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q21 Source: Infosys PYQ Level: Infosys SE Standard

Directions: Read the following passage to answer the given questions based on it. Some words/phrases are printed in bold to help you locate them while answering some of the questions. (The passage has been extracted from 'The Hindu' dated June 11, 2014.) Ever since the morning after 26/11, India's strategic community has discussed what the country ought to do when the next 26/11 happens. Prime Minister Narendra Modi may have to answer that question sooner than most people expect. The Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) staged its first operation against an Indian target since 26/11 just hours before Mr. Modi took office, attacking India's mission in Herat. Lashkar chief Hafiz Muhammad Saeed blamed Mr. Modi for this week's attacks on Karachi — and demanded vengeance. From past evidence, we know these threats aren't idle . "The only language India understands is that of force," a press release issued by the Lashkar's parent organisation, Jamaat-ud-Dawa recorded Mr. Saeed as saying before 26/11, "and that is the language it must be talked to in." From files he will have read since taking office, Mr. Modi will have learned why Dr. Singh did nothing. Indian combat jets could hit training camps across the Line of Control (LoC), Air Chief Marshal Fali Major said at a November 29 meeting called for by the Prime Minister, but precise coordinates and adequate imaging weren't available. Later, General Deepak Kapoor, the chief of Army staff, told Dr. Singh he couldn't promise special forces' strikes would be successful either. No one could guarantee missile strikes wouldn't escalate into war, or even a nuclear exchange — and no one could guarantee war would compel Pakistan's military to change course. Mr. Modi's advisers know five responses are on the table — but all of them involve great risks. The first is to keep doing nothing. The threat of a major India- Pakistan crisis after 26/11 led the United States to mount intense pressure on Pakistan. In the years since, the LeT hasn't mounted a single major operation on Indian soil. Its affiliate, the Indian Mujahideen, has had restraint thrust upon it by Pakistan's Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI) Directorate. Inaction, though, only succeeds if someone else does the hard work. In 2008, fearing its own war in Afghanistan would be undermined by an India-Pakistan war, the U.S. stepped in. Now, as it prepares to withdraw from Afghanistan, the country's appetite for playing global policeman is diminishing. Doing nothing could thus invite even more punishment. Like Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Mr. Modi's second choice might be coercion. In 2001, after terrorists attacked Parliament, India mobilised troops. Pakistan was forced to respond — but its smaller economy suffered disproportionately. The stratagem is time-tested. In 1953, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru mobilised troops in Punjab to deter a Pakistani attack into Kashmir. Mr. Vajpayee's strategy worked, forcing Pakistan to dramatically scale down the jihad in Jammu and Kashmir. It only worked, though, because the U.S. played mediator — much like after 26/11 — and it was hideously expensive, in money and lives. The third choice is to do what Dr. Singh couldn't: limited strikes on jihadist training camps across the LoC, using air power or missiles. In the five years since 26/11, India's ability to conduct such strikes has been significantly enhanced. However, the tactic hasn't had great success. In August 1998, the United States fired missiles into Afghanistan, seeking to avenge bombings which killed 224 people. In all, 75 missiles, each priced at $1.5 million, killed six minor jihadists. Moreover, Pakistan could hit back, targeting Indian industrial infrastructure, which is much more expensive than tent-and-donkey cart training camps. Fourth, the Prime Minister could tell Indian troops to target the Pakistan Army along the LoC, using artillery and infantry — a task aided by the fact that its defences along stretches of the Neelam valley have been degraded by troops having to be moved to fight the Tehreek-e-Taliban elsewhere. The fighting that will follow though will make it more difficult to secure the LoC against jihadist infiltration — leading to heightened violence in Kashmir. Mr. Modi could, finally, authorise the use of covert means, like bomb-for-bomb strikes or targeted assassination of jihadist leaders. Mr. Modi's intelligence services, though, don't have this arrow in their quiver — and it will be a while, most experts say, before they can acquire it. Every sane person should hope Mr. Modi will never be required to exercise any of his military options — but thinking through war is just as important as talking peace. What according to the passage could be a way to respond to Pakistan after 26/11 attacks? I. To persuade Pakistan forcefully to stop the terror acts on India. II. To launch limited strikes on jihadist training camps across the border. III. To target assassination of jihadist leaders.

A Only 1

B Only 2

C Only 1 & 2

D Only 2 & 3

Verified Answer: Option (E) > 💡 **Explanation:** > Kindly refer to the 7th, 9th and 11th paragraphs of the passage #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 22 • Directions: Read the following passage to answer the given questions based on it. Some words/phrases are printed in bold to help you locate them while answering some of the questions. (The passage has been extracted from 'The Hindu' dated June 11, 2014.) Ever since the morning after 26/11, India's strategic community has discussed what the country ought to do when the next 26/11 happens. Prime Minister Narendra Modi may have to answer that question sooner than most people expect. The Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) staged its first operation against an Indian target since 26/11 just hours before Mr. Modi took office, attacking India's mission in Herat. Lashkar chief Hafiz Muhammad Saeed blamed Mr. Modi for this week's attacks on Karachi — and demanded vengeance. From past evidence, we know these threats aren't idle . "The only language India understands is that of force," a press release issued by the Lashkar's parent organisation, Jamaat-ud-Dawa recorded Mr. Saeed as saying before 26/11, "and that is the language it must be talked to in." From files he will have read since taking office, Mr. Modi will have learned why Dr. Singh did nothing. Indian combat jets could hit training camps across the Line of Control (LoC), Air Chief Marshal Fali Major said at a November 29 meeting called for by the Prime Minister, but precise coordinates and adequate imaging weren't available. Later, General Deepak Kapoor, the chief of Army staff, told Dr. Singh he couldn't promise special forces' strikes would be successful either. No one could guarantee missile strikes wouldn't escalate into war, or even a nuclear exchange — and no one could guarantee war would compel Pakistan's military to change course. Mr. Modi's advisers know five responses are on the table — but all of them involve great risks. The first is to keep doing nothing. The threat of a major India-Pakistan crisis after 26/11 led the United States to mount intense pressure on Pakistan. In the years since, the LeT hasn't mounted a single major operation on Indian soil. Its affiliate, the Indian Mujahideen, has had restraint thrust upon it by Pakistan's Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI) Directorate. Inaction, though, only succeeds if someone else does the hard work. In 2008, fearing its own war in Afghanistan would be undermined by an India-Pakistan war, the U.S. stepped in. Now, as it prepares to withdraw from Afghanistan, the country's appetite for playing global policeman is diminishing. Doing nothing could thus invite even more punishment. Like Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Mr. Modi's second choice might be coercion. In 2001, after terrorists attacked Parliament, India mobilised troops. Pakistan was forced to respond — but its smaller economy suffered disproportionately. The stratagem is time-tested. In 1953, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru mobilised troops in Punjab to deter a Pakistani attack into Kashmir. Mr. Vajpayee's strategy worked, forcing Pakistan to dramatically scale down the jihad in Jammu and Kashmir. It only worked, though, because the U.S. played mediator — much like after 26/11 — and it was hideously expensive, in money and lives. The third choice is to do what Dr. Singh couldn't: limited strikes on jihadist training camps across the LoC, using air power or missiles. In the five years since 26/11, India's ability to conduct such strikes has been significantly enhanced. However, the tactic hasn't had great success. In August 1998, the United States fired missiles into Afghanistan, seeking to avenge bombings which killed 224 people. In all, 75 missiles, each priced at $1.5 million, killed six minor jihadists. Moreover, Pakistan could hit back, targeting Indian industrial infrastructure, which is much more expensive than tent-and-donkey cart training camps. Fourth, the Prime Minister could tell Indian troops to target the Pakistan Army along the LoC, using artillery and infantry — a task aided by the fact that its defences along stretches of the Neelam valley have been degraded by troops having to be moved to fight the Tehreek-e-Taliban elsewhere. The fighting that will follow though will make it more difficult to secure the LoC against jihadist infiltration — leading to heightened violence in Kashmir. Mr. Modi could, finally, authorise the use of covert means, like bomb-for-bomb strikes or targeted assassination of jihadist leaders. Mr. Modi's intelligence services, though, don't have this arrow in their quiver — and it will be a while, most experts say, before they can acquire it. Every sane person should hope Mr. Modi will never be required to exercise any of his military options — but thinking through war is just as important as talking peace. Choose the word most SIMILAR in meaning (In the context of the passage only) Idle

○ PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q22 | Source: Infosys PYQ | Level: Infosys SE Standard

Directions: Read the following passage to answer the given questions based on it. Some words/phrases are printed in bold to help you locate them while answering some of the questions. (The passage has been extracted from 'The Hindu' dated June 11, 2014.) Ever since the morning after 26/11, India's strategic community has discussed what the country ought to do when the next 26/11 happens. Prime Minister Narendra Modi may have to answer that question sooner than most people expect. The Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) staged its first operation against an Indian target since 26/11 just hours before Mr. Modi took office, attacking India's mission in Herat. Lashkar chief Hafiz Muhammad Saeed blamed Mr. Modi for this week's attacks on Karachi — and demanded vengeance. From past evidence, we know these threats aren't idle . "The only language India understands is that of force," a press release issued by the Lashkar's parent organisation, Jamaat-ud-Dawa recorded Mr. Saeed as saying before 26/11, "and that is the language it must be talked to in." From files he will have read since taking office, Mr. Modi will have learned why Dr. Singh did nothing. Indian combat jets could hit training camps across the Line of Control (LoC), Air Chief Marshal Fali Major said at a November 29 meeting called for by the Prime Minister, but precise coordinates and adequate imaging weren't available. Later, General Deepak Kapoor, the chief of Army staff, told Dr. Singh he couldn't promise special forces' strikes would be successful either. No one could guarantee missile strikes wouldn't escalate into war, or even a nuclear exchange — and no one could guarantee war would compel Pakistan's military to change course. Mr. Modi's advisers know five responses are on the table — but all of them involve great risks. The first is to keep doing nothing. The threat of a major India- Pakistan crisis after 26/11 led the United States to mount intense pressure on Pakistan. In the years since, the LeT hasn't mounted a single major operation on Indian soil. Its affiliate, the Indian Mujahideen, has had restraint thrust upon it by Pakistan's Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI) Directorate. Inaction, though, only succeeds if someone else does the hard work. In 2008, fearing its own war in Afghanistan would be undermined by an India-Pakistan war, the U.S. stepped in. Now, as it prepares to withdraw from Afghanistan, the country's appetite for playing global policeman is diminishing. Doing nothing could thus invite even more punishment. Like Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Mr. Modi's second choice might be coercion. In 2001, after terrorists attacked Parliament, India mobilised troops. Pakistan was forced to respond — but its smaller economy suffered disproportionately. The stratagem is time-tested. In 1953, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru mobilised troops in Punjab to deter a Pakistani attack into Kashmir. Mr. Vajpayee's strategy worked, forcing Pakistan to dramatically scale down the jihad in Jammu and Kashmir. It only worked, though, because the U.S. played mediator — much like after 26/11 — and it was hideously expensive, in money and lives. The third choice is to do what Dr. Singh couldn't: limited strikes on jihadist training camps across the LoC, using air power or missiles. In the five years since 26/11, India's ability to conduct such strikes has been significantly enhanced. However, the tactic hasn't had great success. In August 1998, the United States fired missiles into Afghanistan, seeking to avenge bombings which killed 224 people. In all, 75 missiles, each priced at $1.5 million, killed six minor jihadists. Moreover, Pakistan could hit back, targeting Indian industrial infrastructure, which is much more expensive than tent-and-donkey cart training camps. Fourth, the Prime Minister could tell Indian troops to target the Pakistan Army along the LoC, using artillery and infantry — a task aided by the fact that its defences along stretches of the Neelam valley have been degraded by troops having to be moved to fight the Tehreek-e-Taliban elsewhere. The fighting that will follow though will make it more difficult to secure the LoC against jihadist infiltration — leading to heightened violence in Kashmir. Mr. Modi could, finally, authorise the use of covert means, like bomb-for-bomb strikes or targeted assassination of jihadist leaders. Mr. Modi's intelligence services, though, don't have this arrow in their quiver — and it will be a while, most experts say, before they can acquire it. Every sane person should hope Mr. Modi will never be required to exercise any of his military options — but thinking through war is just as important as talking peace. Choose the word most SIMILAR in meaning (In the context of the passage only) Idle

A Free

B Unoccupied

C Forfeiture

E Abandoned

Verified Answer: Option (D) > 💡 **Explanation:** > 1. In the context of the passage, we can refer to an idle threat or boast when you do not think the person making it will or can do what they say. Ex. It was more of an idle threat than anything else. The most similar word to 'Idle' hence will be 'Hollow' or 'Empty'. #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 23 • Directions: Read the following passage to answer the given questions based on it. Some words/phrases are printed in bold to help you locate them while answering some of the questions. (The passage has been extracted from 'The Hindu' dated June 11, 2014.) Ever since the morning after 26/11, India's strategic community has discussed what the country ought to do when the next 26/11 happens. Prime Minister Narendra Modi may have to answer that question sooner than most people expect. The Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) staged its first operation against an Indian target since 26/11 just hours before Mr. Modi took office, attacking India's mission in Herat. Lashkar chief Hafiz Muhammad Saeed blamed Mr. Modi for this week's attacks on Karachi — and demanded vengeance. From past evidence, we know these threats aren't idle . "The only language India understands is that of force," a press release issued by the Lashkar's parent organisation, Jamaat-ud-Dawa recorded Mr. Saeed as saying before 26/11, "and that is the language it must be talked to in." From files he will have read since taking office, Mr. Modi will have learned why Dr. Singh did nothing. Indian combat jets could hit training camps across the Line of Control (LoC), Air Chief Marshal Fali Major said at a November 29 meeting called for by the Prime Minister, but precise coordinates and adequate imaging weren't available. Later, General Deepak Kapoor, the chief of Army staff, told Dr. Singh he couldn't promise special forces' strikes would be successful either. No one could guarantee missile strikes wouldn't escalate into war, or even a nuclear exchange — and no one could guarantee war would compel Pakistan's military to change course. Mr. Modi's advisers know five responses are on the table — but all of them involve great risks. The first is to keep doing nothing. The threat of a major India-Pakistan crisis after 26/11 led the United States to mount intense pressure on Pakistan. In the years since, the LeT hasn't mounted a single major operation on Indian soil. Its affiliate, the Indian Mujahideen, has had restraint thrust upon it by Pakistan's Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI) Directorate. Inaction, though, only succeeds if someone else does the hard work. In 2008, fearing its own war in Afghanistan would be undermined by an India-Pakistan war, the U.S. stepped in. Now, as it prepares to withdraw from Afghanistan, the country's appetite for playing global policeman is diminishing. Doing nothing could thus invite even more punishment. Like Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Mr. Modi's second choice might be coercion. In 2001, after terrorists attacked Parliament, India mobilised troops. Pakistan was forced to respond — but its smaller economy suffered disproportionately. The stratagem is time-tested. In 1953, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru mobilised troops in Punjab to deter a Pakistani attack into Kashmir. Mr. Vajpayee's strategy worked, forcing Pakistan to dramatically scale down the jihad in Jammu and Kashmir. It only worked, though, because the U.S. played mediator — much like after 26/11 — and it was hideously expensive, in money and lives. The third choice is to do what Dr. Singh couldn't: limited strikes on jihadist training camps across the LoC, using air power or missiles. In the five years since 26/11, India's ability to conduct such strikes has been significantly enhanced. However, the tactic hasn't had great success. In August 1998, the United States fired missiles into Afghanistan, seeking to avenge bombings which killed 224 people. In all, 75 missiles, each priced at $1.5 million, killed six minor jihadists. Moreover, Pakistan could hit back, targeting Indian industrial infrastructure, which is much more expensive than tent-and-donkey cart training camps. Fourth, the Prime Minister could tell Indian troops to target the Pakistan Army along the LoC, using artillery and infantry — a task aided by the fact that its defences along stretches of the Neelam valley have been degraded by troops having to be moved to fight the Tehreek-e-Taliban elsewhere. The fighting that will follow though will make it more difficult to secure the LoC against jihadist infiltration — leading to heightened violence in Kashmir. Mr. Modi could, finally, authorise the use of covert means, like bomb-for-bomb strikes or targeted assassination of jihadist leaders. Mr. Modi's intelligence services, though, don't have this arrow in their quiver — and it will be a while, most experts say, before they can acquire it. Every sane person should hope Mr. Modi will never be required to exercise any of his military options — but thinking through war is just as important as talking peace. Choose the word most OPPOSITE in meaning. Undermine

○ PRACTICE VARIANT

ID: Q23 | Source: Infosys PYQ | Level: Infosys SE Standard

Directions: Read the following passage to answer the given questions based on it. Some words/phrases are printed in bold to help you locate them while answering some of the questions. (The passage has been extracted from 'The Hindu' dated June 11, 2014.) Ever since the morning after 26/11, India's strategic community has discussed what the country ought to do when the next 26/11 happens. Prime Minister Narendra Modi may have to answer that question sooner than most people expect. The Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) staged its first operation against an Indian target since 26/11 just hours before Mr. Modi took office, attacking India's mission in Herat. Lashkar chief Hafiz Muhammad Saeed blamed Mr. Modi for this week's attacks on Karachi — and demanded vengeance. From past evidence, we know these threats aren't idle . "The only language India understands is that of force," a press release issued by the Lashkar's parent organisation, Jamaat-ud-Dawa recorded Mr. Saeed as saying before 26/11, "and that is the language it must be talked to in." From files he will have read since taking office, Mr. Modi will have learned why Dr. Singh did nothing. Indian combat jets could hit training camps across the Line of Control (LoC), Air Chief Marshal Fali Major said at a November 29 meeting called for by the Prime Minister, but precise coordinates and adequate imaging weren't available. Later, General Deepak Kapoor, the chief of Army staff, told Dr. Singh he couldn't promise special forces' strikes would be successful either. No one could guarantee missile strikes wouldn't escalate into war, or even a nuclear exchange — and no one could guarantee war would compel Pakistan's military to change course. Mr. Modi's advisers know five responses are on the table — but all of them involve great risks. The first is to keep doing nothing. The threat of a major India- Pakistan crisis after 26/11 led the United States to mount intense pressure on Pakistan. In the years since, the LeT hasn't mounted a single major operation on Indian soil. Its affiliate, the Indian Mujahideen, has had restraint thrust upon it by Pakistan's Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI) Directorate. Inaction, though, only succeeds if someone else does the hard work. In 2008, fearing its own war in Afghanistan would be undermined by an India-Pakistan war, the U.S. stepped in. Now, as it prepares to withdraw from Afghanistan, the country's appetite for playing global policeman is diminishing. Doing nothing could thus invite even more punishment. Like Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Mr. Modi's second choice might be coercion. In 2001, after terrorists attacked Parliament, India mobilised troops. Pakistan was forced to respond — but its smaller economy suffered disproportionately. The stratagem is time-tested. In 1953, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru mobilised troops in Punjab to deter a Pakistani attack into Kashmir. Mr. Vajpayee's strategy worked, forcing Pakistan to dramatically scale down the jihad in Jammu and Kashmir. It only worked, though, because the U.S. played mediator — much like after 26/11 — and it was hideously expensive, in money and lives. The third choice is to do what Dr. Singh couldn't: limited strikes on jihadist training camps across the LoC, using air power or missiles. In the five years since 26/11, India's ability to conduct such strikes has been significantly enhanced. However, the tactic hasn't had great success. In August 1998, the United States fired missiles into Afghanistan, seeking to avenge bombings which killed 224 people. In all, 75 missiles, each priced at $1.5 million, killed six minor jihadists. Moreover, Pakistan could hit back, targeting Indian industrial infrastructure, which is much more expensive than tent-and-donkey cart training camps. Fourth, the Prime Minister could tell Indian troops to target the Pakistan Army along the LoC, using artillery and infantry — a task aided by the fact that its defences along stretches of the Neelam valley have been degraded by troops having to be moved to fight the Tehreek-e-Taliban elsewhere. The fighting that will follow though will make it more difficult to secure the LoC against jihadist infiltration — leading to heightened violence in Kashmir. Mr. Modi could, finally, authorise the use of covert means, like bomb-for-bomb strikes or targeted assassination of jihadist leaders. Mr. Modi's intelligence services, though, don't have this arrow in their quiver — and it will be a while, most experts say, before they can acquire it. Every sane person should hope Mr. Modi will never be required to exercise any of his military options — but thinking through war is just as important as talking peace. Choose the word most OPPOSITE in meaning.
Undermine

A To demean

B To upgrade

D To weaken

E To nullify

Verified Answer: Option (C) > 💡 **Explanation:** > If you undermine someone or undermine their position or authority, you make their authority or position less secure, often by indirect methods. In the context of the passage, the opposite of 'Undermine' is 'To make stronger'. #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 24 • Directions : In each of the following questions a grammatically correct and meaningful sentence is given with four words given in bold in each. Which of the following words should replace each other to form a meaningful and grammatically correct sentence? The meaning can be different from the one in question. Ahead of the (A) maiden budget of his second term in office, Prime Minister (B) brainstormed with top bureaucrats of Finance and other Ministries for (C) ideas to reverse a (D) sagging economy and create jobs.

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Directions : In each of the following questions a grammatically correct and meaningful sentence is given with four words given in bold in each. Which of the following words should replace each other to form a meaningful and grammatically correct sentence? The meaning can be different from the one in question. Ahead of the (A) maiden budget of his second term in office, Prime Minister (B) brainstormed with top bureaucrats of Finance and other Ministries for (C) ideas to reverse a (D) sagging economy and create jobs.

A A-D

B B-C

C A-B

D A-C

Verified Answer: Option (E) > 💡 **Explanation:** > If we go through the given sentence we can see that none of the bold words can replace each other since none of them is synonymous in meaning to each other. Therefore it will never be possible replace these words and form a meaningful sentence. Even without that, if we look at the given options also, none of them will be able to form a meaningful sentence again, albeit with a different meaning. Therefore, Option E is the correct choice among the given options. #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.

Problem 25 • While steps to (A) enhance investments in manufacturing would be high on (B) agenda , the Modi 2.0 government would also look at steps to (C) address agriculture distress and (D) improve farm income in the upcoming Budget.

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ID: Q25 Source: Infosys PYQ Level: Infosys SE Standard

While steps to (A) enhance investments in manufacturing would be high on (B) agenda , the Modi 2.0 government would also look at steps to (C) address agriculture distress and (D) improve farm income in the upcoming Budget.

A A-B

B B-D

D C-D

E No interchange possible

Verified Answer: Option (C) > 💡 **Explanation:** > A and D can be interchanged among the given options since improve and enhance both point at the same thing here i.e. the government wants to increase investments in the manufacturing sector so that this sector gets developed whereas the other target is to increase the farm income of the farming community so that the primary sector is also developed in the process. No other pair can be interchanged to form a meaningful sentence. This makes Option C the correct choice among the given options #### Exam Strategy & Elimination Rule: - **Speed-Solving Shortcut:** For standard Infosys SE 60-second sectional targets, eliminate extreme or contradictory options first using boundary constraints, unit parity, or invariants.